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Unit 2

The Post-Mauryan India



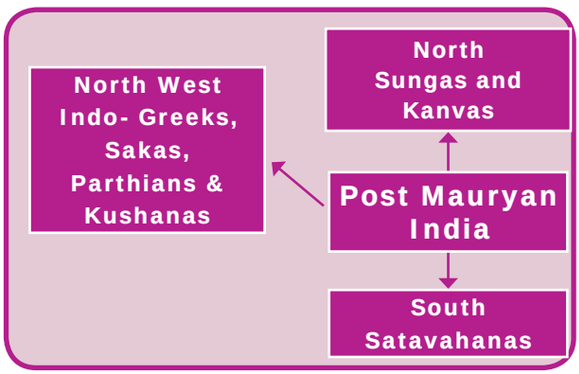
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Learning Objectives

- To acquire knowledge of the history of dynasties and kingdoms that emerged after the breakup of the Mauryan Empire
- To gain an understanding of the polity, society, economy, and culture of various kingdoms that were established in the south, north and north-west of India
- To become familiar with their contributions to early medieval India

Introduction

The break-up of Mauryan Empire resulted in the invasions of Sakas, Scythians, Parthians, Indo-Greeks or Bactrian Greeks and Kushanas from the north-west. In the south, Satavahanas became independent after Asoka's death. There were Sungas and Kanvas in the north before the emergence of Gupta dynasty. Chedis (Kalinga) declared their independence.



It has to be noted here that, though Magadha ceased to be the premier state of India, it continued to be a great centre of Buddhist culture.

Sources

Archaeological Sources

Inscriptions / Copper Plates

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- Ayodhya Inscription of Dana Deva
- Persepolis, Nakshi Rustam Inscriptions
- Moga(Taxila copper plate)
- Junagadh/Girnar Inscription
- Nasik *Eulogy*
- Inscription of Darius I

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